Marketing mix

The successful marketing of a product depends on the consideration of four key elements—the product itself, its price, how it is promoted, and where it is sold. This combination is called the marketing mix, and it is used as a tool for planning product launches and campaigns. Before focusing on the marketing mix, marketers need to define the target market for their product by determining which groups of customers are most likely to purchase it.

The 4Ps and 4Cs of the marketing mix

First proposed in 1960, the classic marketing mix tool contains the 4Ps: product, price, promotion, and place. In the 1990s, these were recast as the 4Cs, which emphasized the customer-oriented dimension of the tool.

The 7Ps of the marketing mix

Some marketers use a more detailed model of the marketing mix, which has three additional elements.

- **Product** *See pp.180–183.*
- **Price** *See pp.186–187.*
- **Place** *See pp.188–189.*
- **Promotion** *See pp.190–191.*
- **People** Does the business employ the right people to deliver optimum service to customers?
- **Process** Are effective systems in place for handling orders and dealing with customer questions and complaints?
- **Physical environment** Does the design and layout of the business premises appeal to customers?

Commodity

- **Has the product been specifically engineered** and designed to meet and exceed customer expectations?

Product

- **Is the product the right design, size, and color** to appeal to customers?
- **What are its unique features?** How does it compare with competitors?

Communication

- **What is the most meaningful way** to get marketing messages to customers and provide them with useful information?

Promotion

- **What combination** of marketing and media channels will be most effective?
- **When is the best time** to run promotions?